



LV.0 → LV.1 · AI ENGINEER

The 3 Y's that move you from **Level 0** → **1** AI engineer.

YOLO, YARN & YAML. **Plain-English** definitions, one swipe each,
plus the two godfathers of deep learning and the platforms to know.

YOU ONLY LOOK ONCE • VISION

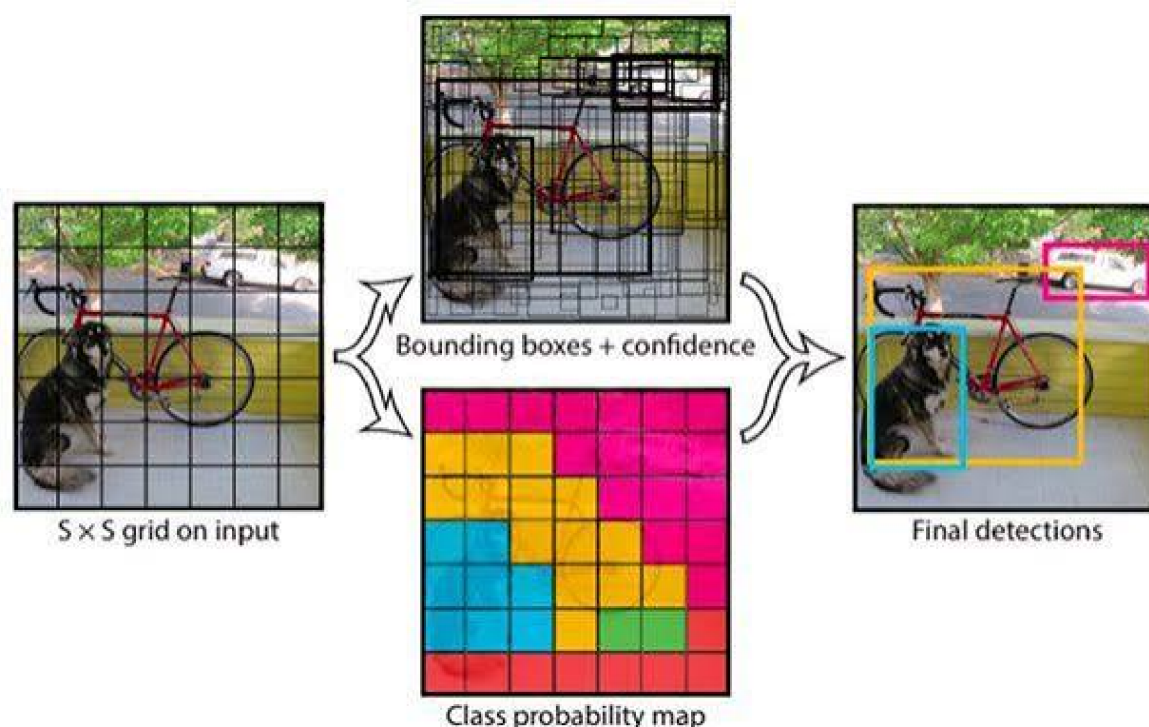
YOLO

one pass • every object • real time

YOLO spots and locates every object in an image in a **single pass of the network**, fast enough for live video, which is why it runs self-driving cars, drones, and smart cameras.

USED IN

- Self-driving cars
- Robotics & drones
- Smart surveillance



GRID → BOXES → DETECTIONS

YET ANOTHER RESOURCE NEGOTIATOR • INFRA

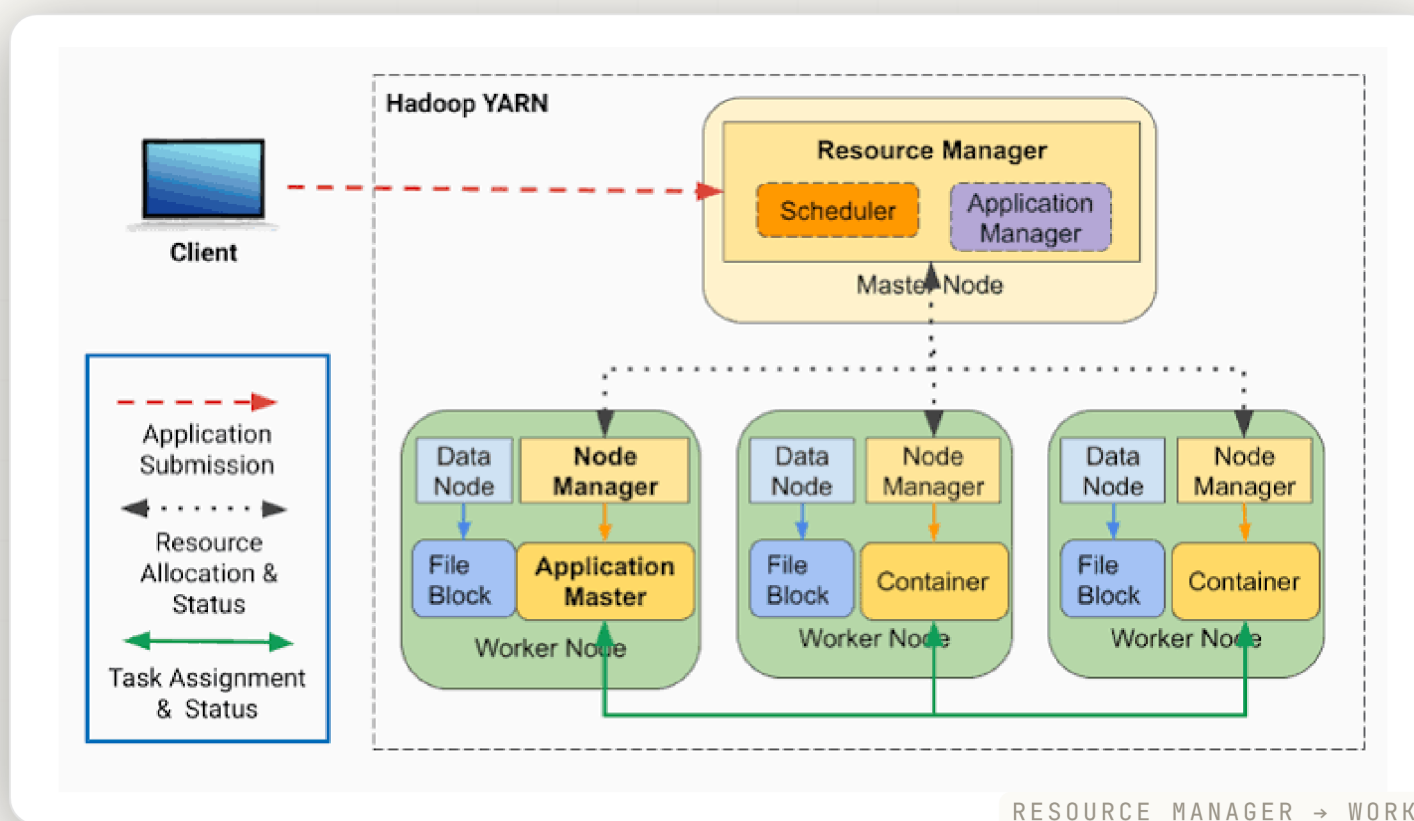
YARN

who gets the CPU • who gets the RAM

YARN is Hadoop's traffic controller, **handing CPU and memory to jobs across a cluster** so big-data and ML workloads share thousands of machines without stepping on each other.

USED IN

- Hadoop clusters
- Big-data pipelines
- Distributed ML



YAML AIN'T MARKUP LANGUAGE • TOOLING

YAML

human-readable config • for everything

YAML is the **human-readable file where ML projects keep their settings**, model params, training runs, deployments, so experiments stay easy to read, reproduce, and tweak.

USED IN

- Model configs
- CI/CD & MLOps
- Kubernetes

```
train_config.yaml

# model + training run
model:
  name: resnet-50
  epochs: 40
  batch_size: 64
optimizer: adam
lr: 0.001
```

ONE CONFIG • REPRODUCIBLE RUNS

↓ UP NEXT • PEOPLE TO FOLLOW

The Y godfathers.

Two **Turing Award winners** whose names start with Y, and who quite literally built the deep learning era we all work in.



HIGH-SIGNAL, LOW-NOISE

Yann LeCun

LinkedIn & X • @ylecun



The inventor of **convolutional neural networks** and a 2018 Turing laureate, now Meta's Chief AI Scientist. He argues today's LLMs are a dead end, and is betting on JEPA world models as the road to machines that grasp the physical world.

2018

Turing Award, with Bengio & Hinton

CNNs

The architecture behind modern vision

JEPA

His bet on what comes after the LLM

THE WORK

Built LeNet, the CNN that first read handwritten digits at scale.

RIGHT NOW

Chief AI Scientist at Meta and professor at NYU.

THE STANCE

Pro open-source AI and a vocal critic of AI-doom narratives.

FOLLOW

in/yann-lecun • @ylecun

HIGH-SIGNAL, LOW-NOISE

Yoshua Bengio

LinkedIn & X • @Yoshua_Bengio



A 2018 Turing laureate and one of the **most-cited scientists alive**. His work on neural nets, attention, and representation learning underpins modern AI — and he now uses that platform to push hard on AI safety.

2018

Turing Award, with LeCun & Hinton

Mila

World's largest deep-learning lab

Safety

A leading scientific voice on AI risk

THE WORK

Early deep nets, word embeddings, and attention mechanisms.

BUILDS

Mila — 1,000+ researchers in Montreal.

THE TURN

Now focused on AI safety, regulation, and governance.

FOLLOW

in/yoshuabengio •
@Yoshua_Bengio

↓ UP NEXT • PLATFORMS TO KNOW

The Y platforms.

Two Y-named names every AI builder runs into,
one funds the startups, the other reinvents how
you search.



STARTUP ACCELERATOR

Y Combinator

funding • mentorship • network



The world's most influential accelerator. Twice a year it backs hundreds of **early-stage startups** with a small check, three months of intense mentorship, and a founder network that compounds for life.

2005

Founded by Paul Graham & co-founders

5,000+

Startups funded since launch

\$600B+

Top alumni value, combined

THE MODEL

A small check for ~7%, then Demo Day before top investors.

BEYOND STARTUPS

Hacker News and Startup School reach millions.

THE NETWORK

Thousands of founders who hire, fund, and advise each other.

APPLY

ycombinator.com • @ycombinator

AI-NATIVE SEARCH

you.com

cited answers • research • APIs



An AI-native search and research platform founded in 2020 by ex-Salesforce AI chief **Richard Socher**. It answers with real-time, citation-backed results and sells the web-search APIs that ground other companies' AI agents in live data.

2020

Founded by Socher & McCann

Cited

Real-time, source-backed answers

APIs

Grounds AI agents in live web data

THE PRODUCT

Chat-first search with modes for code, research, and writing.

THE FOUNDER

Richard Socher, ex-Chief Scientist at Salesforce.

THE BUSINESS

Search APIs that ground enterprise AI in live web data.

FIND THEM

you.com • @YouSearchEngine

The Y stack, in one card.

Save it for later. Drop a comment if there's a Y-term you'd add.

01 **YOLO**

vision

02 **YARN**

infra

03 **YAML**

tooling

@ **Yann LeCun**

people

@ **Yoshua Bengio**

people

+ **Y Combinator**

platform

+ **you.com**

platform



FOLLOW FOR THE FULL A TO Z

Prasanna Kulkarni

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Z Next